

Tough Tape

Short Advertisement Case Study

Project Overview

A 1:26 minute commercial built around a hand-drawn portal taped to everyday objects. The story follows a character who uses this black-hole portal as a shortcut through reality until the cheap tape fails and leaves her stuck inside a TV, delivering the final message: only a tough, reliable tape can "**Hold a universe**" of ideas.

Production Information

Formate

- Duration : 1 min 26 sec
- Resolution : 1920 × 1080
- Frame Rate : 60 fps

Team

- Srushti (Actor & Props)
- Manthan (Director, Cinematographer, Film Editor)
- Pranit (SFX & VFX)

Locations

- CS Building
- University of limerick corridors
- Cappavilla Village

Tools

- Adobe Premiere Pro
- Adobe After Effects

My Contribution

Director

Defined the portal concept, scripted the narrative beats, and guided the actor's performance to hit comedic timing. Worked closely with the team to ensure the gag remained visually readable and playful on camera.

Cinematographer

Planned the shot list and camera compositions, selected lenses and movement to enhance the portal reveals, and balanced exposure across three distinct environments: corridor, kitchen, and TV interior scenes. Used available daylight plus practical fixtures to maintain tonal consistency.

Film Editor

Built the narrative rhythm by pacing cuts to comedic timing and layered transitions to support the visual gags. Synchronized sound effects and music with key visual moments (portal drops, tape failure, character reactions) to reinforce the story beats.

Production Process

Pre-Production

Sketched storyboards for each gag sequence, tested the portal prop with paper and tape to ensure readability in camera, and conducted blocking rehearsals with the actor to confirm the effect worked visually before rolling.

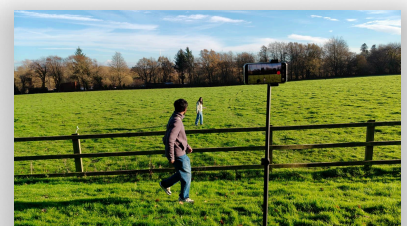
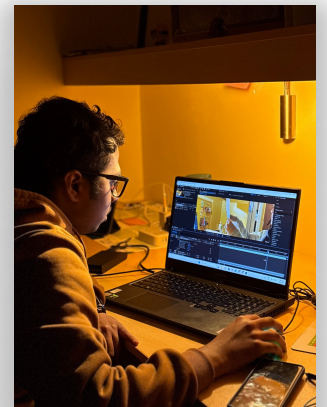
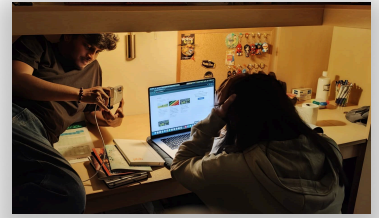
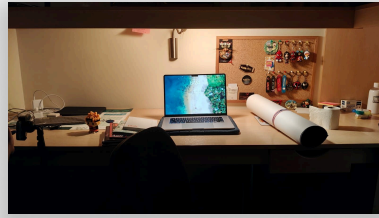
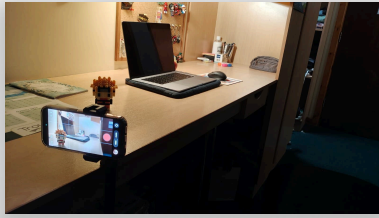
Production

Shot over 5 day using available daylight supplemented with practical lighting fixtures. Captured multiple takes of key moments objects dropping through the portal, the character's reaction to being trapped inside the TV, and the final tape failure beat to have editing options.

Post-Production

Edited selects into a tight 86 second cut, created the black-hole portal effect in After Effects using masking, feathering, and motion tracking, then color-graded for continuity, stabilized handheld footage, mixed sound design and music, and exported an optimized version for YouTube delivery.

Behind the Scenes



Key Production Decisions

Color Grading: Unified the three distinct locations (corridor, kitchen, TV interior) through consistent color treatment to maintain visual cohesion.

Handheld Movement: Used subtle camera movement to convey urgency and playfulness without distracting from the portal gag.

Portal Effect: Built the black-hole illusion using masking and feathering in After Effects, then tracked it to follow the portal's placement on different surfaces.

Sound Design: Layered comedic sound effects with the music to land punchlines at exactly the right moment—especially when the cheap tape fails.

Export Optimization: Maintained visual quality while keeping file size under 25 MB for smooth YouTube delivery.

Creative Reflections

Prop Design Matters: A simple, clear prop (black paper and tape) is more effective on camera than overly complex visuals.

Rehearsal Saves Time: Walking through blocking before shooting meant fewer takes and more confident performances.

Multiple Angles: Having options in the edit with different reaction shots, angles on the tape failure which gave flexibility in the final cut.

Practical Lighting: Using available light with simple bounce boards kept the setup lightweight and mobile across multiple locations.

Sound + Visuals = Comedy: The comedic timing relied heavily on synchronizing sound effects with the visual beat of the portal failing.

Credits

Director / Cinematographer / Film Editor: Manthan Thool

Actor & Props: Srushti Dhobley

Sound Design & VFX: Pranit Mahamuni

Institution: University of Limerick

Date: Nov 2025